

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: June 30,2020

Report Number: VM2020-0067

Report Name: Vietnam Postpones Maximum Levels for Salmonella and Heavy Metals in Feed Ingredients

Country: Vietnam

Post: Hanoi

Report Category: Grain and Feed, Oilseeds and Products, Sanitary/Phytosanitary/Food Safety, WTO Notifications

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Report Highlights:

On June 30, 2020, the Vietnam Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development (MARD) issued Circular 08/2020 to postpone the implementation of new maximum levels (MLs) for Salmonella and heavy metals in feed ingredients of plant origin for one year, until July 1, 2021, for further review and assessment. Vietnam also notified National Technical Regulation (NTR) 190 to the World Trade Organization (WTO) as G/SPS/N/VNM/113 on June 23, 2020. The comment period for this notification closes on July 31, 2020.

Summary

On March 9, 2020, MARD issued Circular 4/2020 promulgating NTR190 – Maximum Allowable Levels (MLs) of Safety Indicators in Animal Feed and Aqua Feed Ingredients ([GAIN Report VM2020-0016](#)). NTR190 set a zero tolerance for *Salmonella*, *Escherichia coli* and renewed tolerances for heavy metals and mycotoxins for all feed ingredients of plant origin imported and domestically produced in Vietnam. This NTR, scheduled to enter into force from July 1, 2020, raised concerns with Vietnam's trading partners about its potential impact on trade.

Following engagement from trading partners, Vietnam notified G/SPS/N/VNM/113 on June 23, 2020, to the WTO, notifying the entire NTR190. This notification gives stakeholders an opportunity to provide Vietnam with comments regarding all new maximum levels in feed and feed ingredients. The comment period closes on July 31, 2020.

On June 30, 2020, MARD officially issued Circular 08/2020 to postpone the implementation of the new maximum levels (MLs) for *Salmonella* and heavy metals, total arsenic (As), cadmium (Cd), lead (Pb), mercury (Hg) in feed ingredients of plant origin, prescribed in Section III, Appendix I of NTR190 for one year, until July 1, 2021 for further review and assessment. An amendment of NTR190 is expected to be published in the first quarter of 2021.

Post will continue to monitor and provide updates on the amendment of this NTR. Should U.S. exporters have any questions, please contact: aghanoi@fas.usda.gov

Attachments:

[Circular08-Postponement of NTR190.docx](#)